

Not Who's Best. Who's Visible. (The Whole of SEO)

Sep 25, 2026 · @Jordan

The brief

This is Jordan's full draft, rebuilt around the five places. **Nothing is cut and it is not split.** Every section of the draft is here. The framework now opens the video instead of arriving 40 minutes in, and every part hangs off it.

- **Series:** VerySEOly (@veryseoly), authority slate. This is the flagship explainer.
- **Presenter:** Jordan Gilbert, Founder, VerySEOly (TicketWave HQ Ltd).
- **Format:** a long-form pillar video, one continuous piece with chapter cards between parts.
- **Runtime:** see Structure at a glance. The draft ran long, and this version keeps all of it and adds the connecting lines.
- **Audience:** UK business owners who want to understand SEO well enough to judge who they hire and what they are sold. Not SEO professionals.
- **Promise (made in the first minute, paid off at the end):** by the end, you will understand the whole system, and you will be able to name the five places your business can be found.
- **Primary CTA:** the audit at veryseoly.com/audit, in the close. **Micro-CTA:** subscribe, right after the five places are introduced.
- **Register:** calm, certain, teaching. EP01 was a manifesto; this is the masterclass. Same authority, lower temperature. You are the person who explains it properly, not the person who sells it.
- **The spine line:** "Not who is best. Who is visible." Planted in the cold open, returned to once in the middle, landed at the end.

What changed from the draft

The five places are now the spine. They are introduced in Part Two, each gets its own part, and the whole of technical, content, performance, accessibility, trust and conversion work sits inside the door as its six layers. The draft already named those six layers; this version uses them as the chapter structure.

Where every draft section went (draft section numbers in brackets):

New part	Draft sections
Cold open	Opening
Part One: Foundations	What is a search engine (1), What is SEO (2), What are we optimising (3)
Part Two: The five places	The framework intro from (49), moved from minute 40 to minute 8
Part Three: The searcher	Search intent (4), Short and long tail (5), Keyword research (6)
Part Four: The answer	Place one from (49), Structured data (14)
Part Five: The map	Place two from (49), Local SEO (25), Google Business Profile (26), NAP (27), Matrix pages (28)
Part Six: The links	Place three from (49), Crawled to converted (7), Page titles (16), Meta descriptions (17)
Part Seven: The reviews	Place four from (49), Reviews (29), Don't obsess over the number (30)
Part Eight: The door	Place five from (49), then six layers. Technical: (8), robots.txt, noindex, (9), (10), (11), (12), (13), (15). Content: (18), (20), (24), (31), (52). Performance: (35), (36), (37). Accessibility: (32), (33), (34). Trust: (21), (22), (23). Conversion: (19)
Part Nine: Measuring it	Search Console (38), Impressions (39), Clicks (40), CTR (41), Average position (42), URL Inspection (43)
Part Ten: The system	Not a button (44), Website as a system (45), Three levels (60), Compounding (46), Asset (47), Google Ads (48), Takes time (62), Long game (63)
Part Eleven: Doing the work	Order of operations (51), Activity is not progress (53 + 56), What SEO is not (54), Spam (55), The loop (57), How I audit (58), Checklist (59), Tomorrow (65)
Close	The real goal (61), Five places recap (50 + 64), The audit tool (66), Final thought (67)

Duplicates resolved without cutting content:

- **The two audit sections** now do different jobs, in sequence: (58) is how Jordan audits a business, (65) is what you do tomorrow, (66) is the tool. They sit together at the end, so the method leads straight into the offer.
- **The two "activity vs progress" sections** (53 and 56) are one section. Every question from both is kept; only the repeated sentence "Activity isn't the same as progress" appears once instead of twice.
- **The three recaps of the five places** are now one preview (Part Two) and one recap (the close). The recap merges (50) and (64) and keeps every line of both.
- **The three levels model** (60) no longer competes with the five places. It is reframed as a second lens on the same system: found, understood, chosen.
- **"Signal, not a switch"** repeats on purpose. It is now a named refrain with an on-screen tag, paid off in "SEO is not a button".

Added: the "Not who is best" line in the cold open, the promise, a short map of the video, a subscribe micro-CTA, a transition line into every part, a short rendering beat (the draft's recap listed rendering but never explained it), a short video beat in the images section (the same issue), and screen and b-roll directions throughout.

Line fixes:

- Noindex story: "But search visibility wasn't the problem. Discoverability was." means the same thing twice. Now: "The page wasn't the problem. The booking system wasn't the problem. Being found was."
- (37) broken sentence "don't become obsessed with getting: A perfect laboratory score..." now reads as two complete sentences.
- (36) heading typo "COre" fixed.
- Every "(Google Help)" and "(Google for Developers)" tag is removed from the spoken lines. Each becomes an on-screen source caption, and all of them are listed in Source notes.
- (29) The reviews claim is re-attributed. The draft credited Google's structured-data guidance with warning against fake and incentivised reviews. The accurate source is Google's Maps user-contributed content policy. The spoken line now says "Google's own policies".

Examples now use Jortech. Every boiler, plumbing, conservatory and bathroom example is now a Jortech tech repair example, and Jortech is named on camera: the navigational search, the demand map, the headings, the images, first-hand experience and the noindex story. This was your decision, and it drops EP01's rule of never naming the repair business, for this video only. Only real Jortech services are used: phone and tablet repair, laptop

and PC repair, console repair, and data recovery. The cross-industry examples (the cold-open trades, dentist, running shoes, the coffee shop, the legal process) stay, to show the ideas apply to any business.

Title and thumbnail

Title: Not Who's Best. Who's Visible. (The Whole of SEO)

If the title needs retesting later, use these as A/B options:

1. The 5 Places Your Business Can Show Up on Google
2. SEO Explained Properly, Without the Nonsense

Thumbnail

- Jordan, composed, direct to camera. Calm authority, not shock.
- Main text: **"WHO'S VISIBLE."** Small line above it, struck through: ~~WHO'S BEST.~~
- Beside Jordan, five stacked labels, like a search results page: ANSWER / MAP / LINKS / REVIEWS / DOOR.
- VerySEOly purple. No robots, no glowing brains, no rocket-ship rankings graph.

Structure at a glance

The script runs to about 10,500 spoken words: about 9,800 from your draft and about 700 new connecting lines. At 140 words a minute, which allows for the one-line-at-a-time pauses and the chapter cards, that is **about 75 minutes**. A brisker read at 155 words a minute brings it to about 68.

Timestamps are estimates at 140 words a minute. Replace them with the real ones after the edit.

Start	Part	Spoken words	What it does
0:00	Cold open	350	The searcher in your town. Plants "Not who is best. Who is visible." Makes the promise.
2:31	Part One: Foundations	670	What a search engine is, what SEO is, what we are optimising
7:18	Part Two: The five places	300	The map of the whole video. Subscribe micro-CTA.

Start	Part	Spoken words	What it does
9:26	Part Three: The searcher	575	Intent, short and long tail, keyword research as a map of demand
13:32	Part Four: The answer	350	Answer surfaces, AI features, structured data
16:03	Part Five: The map	905	Relevance, distance, prominence. Business Profile, NAP, matrix pages.
22:30	Part Six: The links	550	Published to converted, titles, meta descriptions
26:25	Part Seven: The reviews	355	Earned not bought, don't chase the number
28:56	Part Eight: The door	3,260	The spine line returns. Six layers: technical 28:56, content 36:34, performance 41:10, accessibility 43:36, trust 46:17, conversion 49:23
52:14	Part Nine: Measuring it	485	Search Console, impressions, clicks, CTR, average position, URL Inspection
55:42	Part Ten: The system	935	Not a button, the three levels, compounding, the asset, Google Ads, the long game
62:23	Part Eleven: Doing the work	1,170	Order of operations, activity vs progress, spam, the loop, how Jordan audits, the checklist, tomorrow
70:45	The close	615	The audit tool, the real goal, the five places recap, the final line

Where people are likely to stop watching, and what holds them:

- **The first 90 seconds:** the cold open now makes a promise and plants the closing line, so the viewer has a reason to stay.
- **7 to 9 minutes:** the five places map gives a visible route through the video. The corner badge keeps it on screen for the rest of the video.
- **29 to 52 minutes, the door:** it's the longest part, so it's broken into six layer cards, each 2.5 to 7.5 minutes long. The noindex confession at about 31 minutes is the emotional peak of the middle.

- **Every 45 to 90 seconds:** a screen insert, graphic or b-roll cut is written in. No stretch of more than two minutes is face-only.

Full verbatim script

Every spoken word, in order. Stage directions are in italics and brackets. New connecting lines are marked with a * at the start of the paragraph so you can see what was added to your draft; remove the marks for the teleprompter.

Cold open

[Face. Tight framing. Direct eye contact. No music. B-roll in the gaps: a high street, a phone in someone's hand.]

Imagine somebody is standing in your town right now.

They need the thing you sell.

Maybe they need a plumber.

Maybe an electrician.

A solicitor.

A dentist.

A photographer.

A restaurant.

A roofer.

A mechanic.

*A phone repair shop.

A software company.

[Deliver the list quickly, one beat each, rising pace. It should feel like a crowd, not a list.]

Maybe they don't know your business exists.

And that's the important part.

They don't start by thinking about your company.

They start with a problem.

They take out their phone.

They type something.

Or they speak into it.

And they search.

And within seconds, something decides what they see.

[Screen: fast inserts, one per line. An AI answer, a map pack, organic links, star ratings, an image grid, a video carousel, a shopping row, a sponsored result.]

An answer.

A map.

A list of websites.

Reviews.

Images.

Videos.

Products.

Maybe advertisements.

Maybe an AI-generated response.

Maybe several of those things at once.

And somewhere inside all of that is your business.

Or it isn't.

[Hold one beat of silence.]

*And here's the uncomfortable truth.

*The customer never sees every business that could help them.

*They only see the ones that are visible.

*Not who is best.

*Who is visible.

That's what this video is about.

Not just Google rankings.

Not just keywords.

Not just blog posts.

Not just backlinks.

Not just your Google Business Profile.

Not just technical SEO.

I'm going to explain the whole thing.

*How search works. What SEO actually is. And the five places your business can be found when somebody searches for what you sell.

*By the end of this video, you'll be able to name all five, and you'll know exactly what sits behind each one.

Starting with the question that is surprisingly often skipped:

What actually is SEO?

And before we can answer that, we need to answer an even more basic question.

What is a search engine?

[Title card, 3 seconds: NOT WHO'S BEST. WHO'S VISIBLE. / THE WHOLE OF SEO]

Part One: Foundations

[Chapter card: PART ONE / FOUNDATIONS. Low music bed begins.]

What is a search engine?

[Face, medium framing.]

When most people hear the phrase "search engine", they immediately think of Google.

And Google is obviously one of the biggest examples.

But the underlying behaviour is much broader than Google.

[Screen: quick cuts of search bars. YouTube, Amazon, Instagram, Facebook, Google Maps, a marketplace, a website's own search box.]

People search on YouTube.

They search on Amazon.

They search on Instagram.

They search on Facebook.

They search in maps.

They search marketplaces.

They search within websites.

They search for products.

They search for businesses.

They search for people.

They search for answers.

They search for images.

They search for videos.

They search for places.

They search for instructions.

They search for things they don't even know the name of yet.

[Back to face.]

So I want you to separate two ideas.

The first is search as a behaviour.

The second is a particular search engine or search platform.

Search is simply the act of trying to find something.

And the platform is the system helping you find it.

That distinction matters because SEO has become much broader than the old idea of:

"Put some keywords on your website and get to number one on Google."

That's not the whole thing.

SEO is about discoverability.

It's about helping the systems people use to find information understand what you have, who it's for, where it applies, and why it might be useful.

And that can apply to different kinds of content.

A website page.

A product page.

A business profile.

A video.

An image.

An article.

A location.

A piece of documentation.

An author.

An organisation.

And increasingly, information can be surfaced through different search interfaces, including AI-powered features within search.

[On screen, lower-left: Source: Google Search Central, "AI features and your website"]

Google's own current documentation treats AI features as part of Search appearance, alongside things such as images, videos, snippets, title links and business details.

So when I say "search" in this video, I don't want you thinking only about ten blue links.

Search is an interface between:

a person who wants something

and

information that might satisfy that need.

SEO sits in the middle.

[Graphic: PERSON ← SEO → INFORMATION]

So what is SEO?

SEO stands for:

Search Engine Optimisation.

And the basic definition is simple.

SEO is the process of optimising something so that it can be discovered and understood in search.

But I want to make that definition more useful.

Because "optimise your website for search engines" can sound like you're writing for a robot.

You're not.

You're building something for a person.

Then you're making it easier for search systems to understand and surface it.

So here's the definition I want you to remember:

[Slow down. Push in. Text on screen as it is spoken.]

SEO is the work of making the things you want people to find discoverable in the places where they search.

That's the big idea.

And everything else in this video is really an unpacking of that sentence.

What are we actually optimising?

This is where SEO gets interesting.

Because we're not necessarily optimising a website.

We're optimising whatever contains the information that we want discovered.

That might be:

A website.

A page.

A service page.

A product.

A business profile.

A video.

A YouTube channel.

An image.

An article.

A location.

A person's author profile.

An organisation.

A collection of products.

A piece of documentation.

Or a combination of all of them.

And that's why you'll hear people talk about different types of SEO.

[Graphic: the names tile onto the screen one by one.]

Technical SEO.

On-page SEO.

Content SEO.

Local SEO.

Image SEO.

Video SEO.

Ecommerce SEO.

International SEO.

News SEO.

And so on.

These aren't necessarily completely separate disciplines.

They're different applications of the same underlying problem:

[Tiles collapse into one line of text.]

Can the thing be found, understood, trusted and presented to the right person when they search?

That's the foundation.

*So that's what SEO is. Now let's look at where it actually happens.

Part Two: The five places

[Chapter card: PART TWO / THE FIVE PLACES. Face, direct to camera.]

*In this video, we're going to cover a lot.

[Graphic: each word appears and stacks as it is spoken, filling the screen.]

Search.

SEO.

Intent.

Keywords.

Technical SEO.

Content.

E-E-A-T.

Authors.

Local SEO.

Reviews.

Images.

Video.

Accessibility.

Performance.

Search Console.

Organic growth.

Paid search.

[The stack of words clears in one cut.]

*So before we go into any of it, I want to simplify the whole thing.

Not by pretending SEO is simple.

But by giving you a useful mental model.

When someone searches for something you sell, there are several places where your business can become visible.

For this framework, I'm going to keep it to five.

Five.

Not six.

Not twelve.

Five.

[Graphic: five labelled panels build left to right, one per line, styled like parts of a results page. They stay as a corner badge for the rest of the video, with the current place lit.]

*One. The answer. The response search gives before anyone clicks anything.

*Two. The map. Where geography matters, and where local businesses are chosen.

*Three. The links. The traditional organic results, the doorways into websites.

*Four. The reviews. Where your reputation becomes visible.

*Five. The door. Your website, where a searcher becomes a customer.

*The answer. The map. The links. The reviews. The door.

*Everything else in this video, every technical term, every tool, every tactic, belongs to one of those five places.

*And if you're watching this because you run a business, subscribe. One press. Everything on this channel is about making your business easier to find and easier to choose.

[Micro-CTA: under 10 seconds, then straight on.]

*But before we walk through the five places, there's something that comes before all of them.

*The person doing the searching.

Part Three: The searcher

[Chapter card: PART THREE / THE SEARCHER]

Before SEO: what does the person actually want?

Now let's talk about one of the most important concepts in all of SEO.

Search intent.

Because a keyword is not a customer.

A search query is a clue about what the person wants.

*Through a lot of this video, I'm going to use one real business as the example.

*My own.

*Jortech. We repair phones, tablets, laptops and consoles, and we recover data.

[Lower-third: JORTECH, TECH REPAIR, JORTECH.CO.UK]

[Screen: a search box. Type each query as it is spoken.]

Imagine someone searches:

"phone screen"

What do they want?

We don't know.

They might want to buy a replacement screen.

They might want to fix it themselves.

They might want to know what a repair costs.

They might want a screen protector.

They might be looking for a repair shop.

They might be looking for one near them.

Now compare that with:

"cracked iPhone screen repair near me"

That's much more specific.

Or:

"how to fix a phone that won't charge"

Different intent.

Or:

"iPhone 15 screen replacement cost"

Different again.

Or:

"Jortech phone number"

That's navigational.

The person already knows what they're looking for.

*They already know the business by name. They just need the way in.

So you can have the same broad subject and completely different intent.

And if you misunderstand the intent, you can create a technically excellent page that is still the wrong answer.

That's one of the biggest mistakes in SEO.

People ask:

"What keyword should I rank for?"

A better question is:

[Text on screen.]

"What is the person actually trying to accomplish?"

Short-tail and long-tail search terms

You'll often hear SEO people talk about short-tail and long-tail keywords.

A short-tail term might be:

"phone repair"

"dentist"

"running shoes"

"SEO"

A long-tail search might be:

"iPhone screen repair open now in Leeds"

"best running shoes for flat feet under £100"

"how to fix a WordPress canonical error"

Long-tail doesn't necessarily mean "better."

And short-tail doesn't necessarily mean "worse."

They represent different levels of specificity.

The more specific the search, often the clearer the person's intent becomes.

But there is another important lesson here.

Search volume is not the same thing as business value.

A keyword with 100,000 searches isn't automatically more valuable to your business than a keyword with 500.

If those 500 people are looking for exactly what you sell, the smaller audience may matter enormously.

SEO isn't a popularity contest.

It's about matching demand with relevance.

Keyword research

Keywords still matter.

Anyone telling you that words people type into search don't matter is making this more complicated than it needs to be.

Search engines need to understand what a page is about.

And users need to recognise that your result is relevant to what they're looking for.

But modern SEO shouldn't mean repeating the same phrase 47 times.

You start with the subject.

Then you understand the different ways people describe it.

Then you understand the questions around it.

Then you understand the different intents.

Then you build useful resources around those needs.

For example, take a tech repair business like Jortech.

[Graphic: a demand map builds. "Tech repair" in the centre, services branching off, questions hanging off each service.]

You might have:

Phone screen repair.

Battery replacement.

Laptop repair.

Console repair.

Water damage repair.

Data recovery.

And questions:

How much does a phone screen repair cost?

How long does a laptop repair take?

How do I know whether my laptop is worth repairing?

What should I do if my phone gets wet?

Those aren't simply a list of keywords.

They're a map of customer problems.

That's how I want you thinking about keyword research.

[Text on screen.]

Don't build a keyword list. Build a map of demand.

*Now you know what the person wants. So let's follow them into the five places, starting with the first thing search shows them.

Part Four: Place one, the answer

[Chapter card: PLACE ONE / THE ANSWER. Corner badge: ANSWER lit.]

The first place is:

The answer.

[Screen: a search that returns an AI Overview, then a featured result, then a knowledge panel.]

Search engines increasingly provide answers directly.

Sometimes that's a traditional featured result.

Sometimes a knowledge result.

Sometimes a local summary.

Sometimes an AI-powered search feature.

[On screen: Source: Google Search Central, "AI features and your website"]

Google's current Search documentation includes AI Overviews and AI Mode among its search features.

The important thing isn't to invent some mystical new thing called:

"AI SEO."

There isn't a button you press that says:

"Make ChatGPT recommend my business."

The underlying principles still matter.

Can your information be discovered?

Can it be understood?

Is it useful?

Is it trustworthy?

Is the underlying entity clear?

Does the content genuinely answer questions?

Can search systems access it?

Those fundamentals don't disappear because the interface changes.

The interface can change.

The underlying need remains.

[Text on screen.]

Be useful enough to be found and understood.

*And one of the ways you make the underlying entity clear, in a language machines read directly, is structured data.

Structured data

This is where you provide machine-readable information about what a page represents.

[Screen: a short, clean block of Organization or LocalBusiness markup beside the page it describes. Illustrative only, no real client code.]

For example:

An article.

A product.

An organisation.

A local business.

An event.

A breadcrumb.

And other supported entities and features.

[On screen: Source: Google Search Central, "Introduction to structured data"]

Google says structured data can help it understand the content of a page and can make pages eligible for certain richer search features. But structured data is not a magic ranking switch.

[Refrain tag, bottom of frame: SIGNAL, NOT A SWITCH]

That's another distinction worth remembering.

Eligibility is not guaranteed appearance.

You can implement valid structured data and still not receive the visual feature you were hoping for.

And you should never mark up information that isn't actually present or accurate.

*The answer is where search speaks for you. The next place is where geography decides.

Part Five: Place two, the map

[Chapter card: PLACE TWO / THE MAP. Corner badge: MAP lit.]

The second place is:

The map.

This is particularly important for local businesses.

You want the business to be understood as:

the right business,

in the right place,

offering the right thing.

Local SEO

*This is local SEO, one of the biggest areas for local businesses.

And local search is different because location matters.

[Screen: the same search, "coffee shop", shown with an Amsterdam map pack, then a Manchester one.]

If I search:

"coffee shop"

the results I want in Amsterdam aren't the same results I want in Manchester.

If I search:

"phone screen repair"

the physical location of the business can be extremely important.

[On screen: Source: Google Business Profile Help, "Tips to improve your local ranking on Google"]

Google currently says local results are mainly based on:

relevance, distance and prominence.

Let's unpack those.

Relevance

[Graphic: RELEVANCE / DISTANCE / PROMINENCE, lighting one at a time.]

Does the business match what the person is looking for?

If someone searches for a dentist, a dentist is relevant.

A bicycle shop isn't.

If someone searches for console repair, a shop that actually repairs consoles is more relevant than one that only sells phone cases.

So your business information needs to make the business understandable.

Distance

How far is the business from the relevant location?

This can be the searcher's location or a location included in the query.

And this is important because local SEO isn't simply:

"Put the town name on your website."

Physical geography matters.

Prominence

Then there's prominence.

How well known is the business?

Google says prominence can be informed by things such as links from other websites and reviews, among other information.

This is where local SEO starts overlapping with wider SEO.

Your website matters.

Your reputation matters.

Other websites matter.

Your business profile matters.

Your reviews matter.

And the information Google receives from across the web can matter.

Google Business Profile

Your Google Business Profile is one of the obvious foundations for a local business.

[Screen: Jortech's Google Business Profile. Make sure every field is complete and accurate before filming.]

Make sure the business is represented accurately.

Business name.

Category.

Address where applicable.

Opening hours.

Phone number.

Website.

Services.

Photos.

Other relevant business information.

Google itself recommends keeping business information complete and accurate, responding to reviews, and adding photos and videos.

But don't confuse "complete profile" with:

"Google now owes me position one."

It doesn't.

A complete profile makes your business easier to understand.

It doesn't give you a guaranteed ranking.

And Google explicitly says there is no way to request or pay for a better local ranking.

[Hold that line on screen as a quote card.]

NAP

You'll also hear the term NAP.

Name.

Address.

Phone number.

The principle is simple:

Your business information should be accurate and coherent.

[Graphic: the same business on a website, a directory, a Business Profile, an old page and a social profile, each with a slightly different phone number or address. Mismatches flash.]

If your website says one phone number.

A directory says another.

Your business profile says something else.

An old page has an old address.

A social profile has another version.

You've created unnecessary confusion.

But don't fall into the trap of thinking there is some magical SEO superstition around whether every comma, abbreviation and punctuation mark is identical everywhere.

The important thing is accuracy and consistency of the underlying business information.

Local SEO matrix pages

Now let's talk about something that can be extremely powerful and extremely badly abused.

Local SEO matrix pages.

*These pages live on your website, but they exist to serve the map, so they belong here.

Imagine you provide:

Phone repair.

And you serve:

Leeds.

Bradford.

Wakefield.

Huddersfield.

You might naturally have pages around real service areas.

But here's the trap.

[Screen: four browser tabs side by side, identical pages with only the town name changed.]

You create:

/phone-repair-leeds

/phone-repair-bradford

/phone-repair-wakefield

/phone-repair-huddersfield

and then copy the same page four times.

You change the town name.

Everything else stays the same.

That's not a strategy.

That's a page factory.

And if the pages exist purely to capture searches while offering little unique value, you've created exactly the kind of doorway/thin-content problem you should be avoiding.

The question isn't:

"Can I make a page for this town?"

The question is:

"Does this town genuinely deserve a useful page?"

Maybe it does.

If you genuinely operate there.

If customers actually use the service there.

If you can provide meaningful local information.

If you have real examples.

If you can explain availability.

If you can show relevant projects.

If you can answer local questions.

If the page genuinely helps somebody.

Then the page can have a reason to exist.

A legitimate local content architecture might look like:

Service × Location

[Graphic: a grid of services by towns. Most cells stay grey; only the cells with real work, real examples and real demand light up.]

But every intersection has to earn its existence.

The map, summed up

*So, the map.

Google currently describes local ranking primarily through relevance, distance and prominence.

That means you should think about:

Your Business Profile.

Your categories.

Your services.

Your opening hours.

Your address where appropriate.

Your website.

Your photos.

Your reviews.

Your reputation.

Your local relevance.

And your wider presence across the web.

But remember:

Nobody can legitimately sell you a guaranteed Google Maps position.

Google itself says there is no way to request or pay for a better local ranking.

Part Six: Place three, the links

[Chapter card: PLACE THREE / THE LINKS. Corner badge: LINKS lit.]

Third:

The links.

The traditional organic search results.

This is where your website pages can appear.

And this is where almost everything in this video comes together.

[Graphic: the words below orbit a single organic result.]

Technical accessibility.

Search intent.

Keywords.

Page titles.

Content.

Internal linking.

Authors.

Experience.

Trust.

Performance.

Images.

Structured data.

External references.

Useful information.

A search result is not the website.

It's the doorway to the website.

And that means you need both:

visibility

and

a reason to click.

*Let's take visibility first.

Published is not ranked: the six stages

Now we're going to get technical.

Because before Google can rank your page, it has to be able to discover and process it.

And this gives us one of the most important distinctions in SEO:

Crawling is not indexing.

And indexing is not ranking.

And ranking is not clicking.

And clicking is not becoming a customer.

Let's slow that down.

[Graphic: a six-stage pipeline builds as each stage is spoken. A page icon travels along it.]

You publish a page.

That doesn't necessarily mean Google has crawled it.

Google discovers URLs through links, sitemaps and other mechanisms.

It then crawls the page.

It processes what it finds.

If the page is eligible and useful enough to be indexed, it may enter Google's index.

Then, when somebody searches, Google's systems decide whether that page is relevant enough to appear.

Then where it appears.

Then whether the searcher actually clicks it.

Then whether the visitor actually becomes a customer.

So:

Published.

Crawled.

Indexed.

Ranked.

Clicked.

Converted.

Those are six different things.

And confusing them causes an enormous amount of bad SEO advice.

[On screen: Source: Google Search Central, "In-depth guide to how Google Search works"]

Google itself recommends understanding crawling, indexing and serving when diagnosing Search-related issues.

*The machinery that gets a page crawled and indexed lives inside your website, so it belongs to the door. We'll open it up properly in Part Eight.

*For now, the reason to click. And that starts with two things you write yourself.

Page titles

Let's start with the title.

[Screen: a single search result, title link highlighted.]

The title tells users and search systems what the page is about.

A good title is descriptive.

It should represent the actual page.

It shouldn't be a collection of keywords.

If the page is:

"iPhone Screen Repair in Leeds"

then say what the page is.

Don't turn it into:

[Screen: the stuffed title typed out in full, visibly absurd.]

"Phone Phone Repair Leeds iPhone Repair Screen Repair Leeds Cheap Phone Repair Best Phone Repair Shop Leeds."

That isn't optimisation.

That's noise.

Meta descriptions

Then we have meta descriptions.

[Screen: the same result, snippet highlighted.]

This is another area where SEO mythology gets ahead of reality.

A meta description is not simply:

"Write this perfectly and Google will rank you higher."

Google may use the meta description as part of the search result snippet, but the displayed snippet can vary depending on the query and page content.

So think about it as search-result presentation.

Its job is to help communicate what the page offers.

It's not a secret ranking lever.

[Refrain tag: SIGNAL, NOT A SWITCH]

That's an important distinction.

*That's the links. Visibility, and a reason to click. But before anyone clicks, many of them look at one more thing.

Part Seven: Place four, the reviews

[Chapter card: PLACE FOUR / THE REVIEWS. Corner badge: REVIEWS lit.]

Fourth:

The reviews.

This is where your reputation becomes visible.

People don't just want to know:

"Can this company provide the service?"

They want to know:

"Do other people trust them?"

"Have they done this before?"

"What happened to previous customers?"

Reviews are not a replacement for good SEO.

They're not a replacement for a good website.

They're not a replacement for a good business.

They're part of the broader reputation system around the business.

Reviews are earned, not bought

Now reviews.

Reviews are not something you buy.

At least they shouldn't be.

Don't manufacture them.

Don't create fake customers.

Don't pay random people to pretend they used your service.

Don't build a system designed to fabricate reputation.

[On screen: Source: Google Maps user-contributed content policy]

Google's own policies prohibit fake reviews, and reviews that are paid for or incentivised.

Instead:

Do good work.

Ask genuine customers for honest feedback.

Make the process easy.

Ask at an appropriate point.

And respond professionally.

If someone leaves a great review, thank them.

If someone leaves a negative review, don't turn your business profile into a public argument.

Address the issue.

Invite the conversation offline where appropriate.

And remember:

A review isn't just an SEO object.

It's a piece of information another potential customer is reading.

Don't obsess over the number

There's another mistake here.

People ask:

"How many reviews do I need?"

There isn't a universal magic number where Google says:

"Congratulations. You now have 147 reviews. You may enter the top three."

Local visibility is more complicated than that.

Google explicitly describes local ranking using multiple factors, including relevance, distance and prominence.

Reviews are one part of the picture.

And for the customer, quality and relevance matter too.

A person isn't necessarily asking:

"Does this company have exactly 4.7 stars?"

They're asking:

"Can I trust these people?"

"Have they done this before?"

"What do customers say?"

"Are they nearby?"

"Do they actually provide the service I need?"

The reviews, summed up

*So, the reviews.

Ask real customers.

Make it easy.

Don't fabricate.

Don't manipulate.

Respond professionally.

And remember that the customer is reading the review, not an algorithm.

Part Eight: Place five, the door

[Chapter card: PLACE FIVE / THE DOOR. Corner badge: DOOR lit. Face, direct.]

And finally:

The door.

Your website.

This is where the person arrives after you've earned the click.

And this is why I call it the door.

Because your website is where someone can move from:

searcher

to

visitor

to

prospect

to

customer.

*Remember the line from the start.

*Not who is best. Who is visible.

*The first four places make you visible. The door is where visible becomes chosen.

And everything technical in SEO belongs inside this place.

Technical SEO isn't a sixth place.

It's part of the door.

Because if the door is locked, beautifully decorating the hallway doesn't help.

[B-roll: a locked front door, then a beautifully decorated hallway behind it that nobody reaches.]

If the page is noindex, the page may not enter the index.

If the page is broken, the customer can't use it.

If the page is painfully slow, people may leave.

If the service isn't explained, people may leave.

If the contact form doesn't work, the conversion is lost.

If nobody knows who you are, trust is weakened.

If the page doesn't match the search intent, the visitor is in the wrong room.

So the door has layers.

[Graphic: a door with six stacked layers labelled in order. Each lights as its layer begins.]

Technical.

Content.

Performance.

Accessibility.

Trust.

Conversion.

But it's still one place:

the website.

*Let's open it, one layer at a time.

Layer one: technical

[Layer card: 1 / TECHNICAL]

This is technical SEO.

And I want to make something very clear.

Technical SEO is not just:

"Make your website fast."

That's one tiny part of it.

Technical SEO is about making the website accessible to search systems and users, and making the site's structure understandable and functional.

Let's go through the major pieces.

Crawling

A search engine needs to be able to access your content.

If a page cannot be reached, that's a problem.

If important content is hidden behind systems a crawler can't use properly, that's a problem.

If internal links don't lead to important pages, that's a problem.

If your website architecture is chaotic, that's a problem.

Rendering

*Then there's rendering.

*Many modern websites build parts of the page with JavaScript, in the browser.

*To see that content, Google has to render the page, much like a browser does.

*If your important content, or your links, only appear after scripts run, and something in that process fails, Google may not see what your customers see.

*So one simple question matters: can the important content and links be seen in the page Google actually renders? The URL Inspection tool in Search Console will show you, and we'll get to it in Part Nine.

Robots.txt

Then there's robots.txt.

[Screen: a short robots.txt file.]

This file can provide instructions about which areas crawlers should or shouldn't request.

But here's an important distinction:

robots.txt is not the same thing as noindex.

And blocking crawling isn't the same thing as removing a URL from search.

You have to understand what each control actually does before using it.

Noindex

Then there's the noindex directive.

[Screen: a single meta robots noindex tag in page source, highlighted.]

This tells compliant search engines that the page should not be included in their index.

And this is one of those tiny technical details that can have enormous consequences.

Because if you accidentally put noindex on the page you desperately want people to find...

your beautifully written page isn't going to solve that problem.

[Face. Slow down. This is a confession, not a lesson.]

I know that because I've done it.

I once had a booking page on Jortech, my own repair business, carrying a noindex directive for far too long.

[Screen: a recreation of the Jortech booking page, with the noindex tag highlighted in the page source. Never show real customer bookings.]

The page existed.

The booking system worked.

Customers could use it if they reached it.

The page wasn't the problem.

The booking system wasn't the problem.

Being found was.

Nobody complained.

Nobody emailed me saying:

"Jordan, your SEO is broken."

They simply didn't find the page.

That's an important lesson.

SEO failures aren't always dramatic.

Sometimes they're invisible.

[Hold one beat.]

XML sitemaps

Then we have XML sitemaps.

A sitemap can help search engines discover URLs that you want crawled.

But submitting a sitemap does not mean:

"Google, please rank all of these."

It doesn't guarantee indexing.

It doesn't guarantee ranking.

It is a discovery mechanism and a useful diagnostic resource.

Think of it as handing the search engine a map of URLs that matter.

Not a command to rank them.

Canonicals

Then we get to canonical URLs.

Suppose the same or substantially similar content is accessible through multiple URLs.

[Screen: the three URLs stacked, then an arrow from two of them to the preferred one.]

You might have:

/service

/service/

/service?source=facebook

or multiple URL variations created by filters, parameters or technical architecture.

Canonicalisation gives search engines a signal about which URL you consider the preferred version.

Again:

signal, not magic command.

[Refrain tag: SIGNAL, NOT A SWITCH]

SEO is full of these distinctions.

People often look for switches.

Search is much messier than that.

Redirects and status codes

You also need to understand HTTP status codes.

[Graphic: each code appears as a clean card as it is spoken.]

A 200 generally means:

"The request succeeded."

A 301 is a permanent redirect.

A 302 is a temporary redirect.

A 404 means the resource wasn't found.

5xx errors indicate server-side failures.

You don't need to become a server engineer.

But if you're responsible for SEO, you should understand what these things mean.

Because moving a website without understanding redirects can destroy useful pathways into the site.

Changing URLs can break links.

Deleting pages can remove search visibility.

Launching a redesign can introduce technical problems that weren't there before.

This is why technical SEO matters.

It's infrastructure.

Internal linking

Now something much less glamorous.

Internal links.

The links between pages on your own website.

These matter for users.

They help people navigate.

And they help search engines discover and understand relationships between pages.

[Graphic: a floor plan. Rooms labelled Home, Services, Guides, Contact. Doors appear between them as they are mentioned.]

Imagine your website as a building.

Your homepage is one room.

Your service pages are other rooms.

Your guides are other rooms.

Your contact page is another room.

If there are no doors between important rooms, people and crawlers can struggle to move through the building.

Good internal linking creates pathways.

And it also communicates relationships.

A page about phone screen repair might link to:

battery replacement,

water damage repair,

charging port repair,

pricing,

and relevant guides.

That's not keyword stuffing.

That's information architecture.

Information architecture

This is another phrase worth understanding.

Information architecture.

It simply means organising information so that it makes sense.

Your website should have a logical structure.

People should be able to understand:

Who you are.

What you do.

Where you operate.

What you sell.

What problems you solve.

How your services relate to one another.

How to contact you.

And search engines should be able to discover those relationships too.

This is why SEO isn't just a marketing activity.

It can expose weaknesses in the underlying structure of a business website.

Mobile

Now let's talk about mobile.

[B-roll: someone searching on a phone in a shop, in a parked car, walking down a street.]

Your customer is often not sitting at a desk.

They're standing in a shop.

Sitting in a car.

Walking down a street.

Holding a phone.

Searching quickly.

Your page needs to work properly on that device.

Text needs to be readable.

Buttons need to be usable.

Forms need to work.

Navigation needs to make sense.

Content shouldn't jump around unnecessarily.

And the main information shouldn't be buried under a mountain of pop-ups.

Mobile isn't a special SEO trick.

It's simply part of building a website for the way people actually use the web.

Layer two: content

[Layer card: 2 / CONTENT]

Now we're at the part most people think SEO is.

Content.

And content matters enormously.

But content does not mean:

"Write 2,000 words because Google likes long articles."

There is no universal ideal word count.

Sometimes the best answer is 200 words.

Sometimes it is 2,000.

Sometimes it is a calculator.

Sometimes it's a table.

Sometimes it's a product page.

Sometimes it's a video.

Sometimes it's a map.

The right amount of content is:

the amount needed to satisfy the user's need properly.

If someone wants your opening hours, don't make them read 2,000 words.

If someone wants to understand a complicated legal process, 200 words might be nowhere near enough.

Content length should follow the problem.

Not a superstition.

Headings

Then there are headings.

H1.

H2.

H3.

These help structure the content.

But don't turn heading levels into some kind of SEO ritual.

The purpose is clarity.

A page about laptop repair might have:

[Screen: the heading outline builds as spoken.]

H1 — Laptop Repair in Leeds

H2 — Common Laptop Problems

H2 — Screen and Keyboard Replacement

H2 — How Much Does Laptop Repair Cost?

H2 — When Is a Laptop Worth Replacing?

That creates structure.

It makes the page easier to scan.

And it helps communicate the organisation of the information.

The goal isn't:

"How many keywords can I put in H2 tags?"

The goal is:

Can a human understand this page quickly?

Keyword stuffing

Let's kill another old idea.

You do not need to repeat your target phrase endlessly.

If you're writing:

"Laptop repair Leeds"

and every paragraph contains:

[Screen: the phrase highlighted in every paragraph of a page, multiplying.]

"laptop repair Leeds"

"laptop repair Leeds"

"laptop repair Leeds"

the page starts sounding like it was written for an algorithm rather than a human.

Search engines have much more sophisticated ways of understanding language and content than simple exact-match repetition.

Write naturally.

Use the terminology your customers actually use.

Cover the subject properly.

Answer related questions.

Explain the service.

And make the page genuinely useful.

What about blogging?

Let's talk about blogging because this is where businesses get sold some nonsense.

You don't need a blog because:

"Google likes websites that blog."

You need useful content because your customers have questions.

Those questions can become content.

Suppose you offer data recovery.

People might ask:

Can you recover files from a laptop that won't turn on?

How much does data recovery cost?

How long does it take?

Can photos be recovered from a phone that's been in water?

Is my data kept private while you work on it?

How do I stop it happening again?

Those are legitimate information needs.

Create genuinely useful answers.

But don't publish:

"10 reasons why our repair shop is amazing."

every Tuesday.

Content should exist for a reason.

Images

Now images.

Images are content.

And they can also create problems.

A huge uncompressed image can slow a page.

A poorly named image can provide little useful context.

An image without appropriate alternative text can create accessibility problems.

And an image that's important to understanding the page shouldn't be treated as if it doesn't matter.

Think about:

File size.

Dimensions.

Format.

Compression.

Responsive images.

Descriptive filenames where useful.

Alt text.

Captions where useful.

Surrounding text.

And, above all, relevance.

If the image is a photograph of a cracked iPhone screen being repaired, the filename shouldn't necessarily be:

[Screen: the two filenames side by side.]

IMG_839201.jpg

If you can meaningfully describe it, something like:

iphone-screen-repair-leeds.jpg

is more informative.

But don't turn alt text into:

"best iPhone screen repair Leeds phone repair shop Leeds."

Alt text is not a keyword dumping ground.

Its primary job is to communicate the image's purpose or content when the image can't be perceived.

Video

*And the same thinking applies to video.

*A video is content too.

*Give it a clear title and a description that says what it covers.

*Put it on a page where it's genuinely relevant.

*And give it captions or a transcript, which we'll come to shortly, so the substance isn't locked inside the audio.

Layer three: performance

[Layer card: 3 / PERFORMANCE]

Now we're going to talk about performance.

Because a website can have excellent information and still be painful to use.

[On screen: Source: Google Search Central, "Understanding page experience in Google Search results"]

Google's current documentation says its core ranking systems use a variety of signals related to page experience, and specifically that Core Web Vitals are used by ranking systems. But Google also says good Core Web Vitals do not guarantee top rankings, and warns against chasing a perfect score purely for SEO.

That's exactly how I want you to think about this.

[Text on screen.]

Don't optimise the score.

Optimise the experience.

Core Web Vitals

The current Core Web Vitals are:

[Graphic: three cards, each with a one-line plain-English meaning.]

LCP — Largest Contentful Paint

This is about how quickly the main content becomes visible.

INP — Interaction to Next Paint

This is about responsiveness to interactions.

CLS — Cumulative Layout Shift

This is about unexpected movement of the page.

These are useful because they translate technical behaviour into things users actually experience.

[Screen: a phone. The page loads, a button is tapped and responds, then a badly built page jumps as an advert loads above the text.]

A page loads.

The customer sees the main content.

They tap a button.

The site responds.

They start reading.

The page doesn't suddenly jump because an advert or image loaded above what they were reading.

That's real user experience.

PageSpeed Insights

So use PageSpeed Insights.

[Screen: a PageSpeed Insights report on a demo site.]

Use Lighthouse.

Use your browser's developer tools when necessary.

And use real-user data where available.

But don't become obsessed with getting a perfect laboratory score.

A perfect laboratory score is not the purpose of your website.

A customer doesn't care whether your Lighthouse report says 97.

They care whether the page loads.

Whether they can read it.

Whether the button works.

Whether the form works.

Whether they can find your phone number.

Whether the website doesn't feel broken.

Whether they can actually buy or book.

That is the objective.

Layer four: accessibility

[Layer card: 4 / ACCESSIBILITY]

Accessibility deserves its own layer.

[Screen: a keyboard-only user tabbing through a form, focus ring visible. Then a screen reader reading a well-labelled form.]

Can somebody navigate your website using a keyboard?

Can they understand the headings?

Are forms labelled properly?

Is there sufficient contrast?

Can a screen reader make sense of the page?

Are images described appropriately when necessary?

Are interactive elements usable?

Are videos captioned?

Can people tell where focus is?

Can someone complete your contact form without needing perfect vision, perfect hearing, perfect dexterity and perfect motor control?

These are not merely SEO tricks.

They're quality-of-website questions.

Don't sell accessibility as:

"Google gives you extra ranking points if you add alt text."

That's not the right model.

Build an accessible website because people use your website.

And because a website that communicates clearly to a broader range of people is simply a better website.

Captions

Captions are another useful example.

A caption can give an image context.

It can tell someone what they're looking at.

For video, captions are even more important.

They make spoken content accessible to people who can't or don't want to hear the audio.

They can also improve comprehension.

And a transcript can make the substance of a video available as text.

But again:

Don't turn accessibility features into fake SEO tricks.

Do them because they make the content better.

Good SEO and good accessibility often overlap because both are pushing you toward clearer, more understandable content.

But they're not identical systems.

Readability and Flesch

Now let's talk about readability.

You may have heard of the Flesch Reading Ease score or Flesch-Kincaid.

These formulas attempt to estimate how easy text is to read using characteristics such as sentence length and word length.

They can be useful editorial tools.

But don't turn them into another SEO superstition.

There is no magic rule saying:

"Get your Flesch score to 72 and Google will rank you."

Instead, ask:

Can people understand this?

Are the sentences unnecessarily complicated?

Are paragraphs too long?

Are headings useful?

Can somebody scan the page?

Are technical terms explained?

Can a normal customer understand what we're saying?

Sometimes expert content needs technical language.

That's fine.

The answer isn't to dumb everything down.

The answer is to explain it properly.

Layer five: trust

[Layer card: 5 / TRUST]

E-E-A-T

This brings us to E-E-A-T.

[Graphic: the four words, one at a time.]

Experience.

Expertise.

Authoritativeness.

Trustworthiness.

You'll hear E-E-A-T everywhere in modern SEO.

But here's what I don't want you to do.

Don't turn it into:

"Google gives me an E-E-A-T score of 73."

That's not how you should think about it.

Think about what those ideas represent.

Experience:

Have you actually done the thing?

Expertise:

Do you understand it?

Authoritativeness:

Do other credible signals support your authority in the subject?

Trustworthiness:

Can people reasonably trust the information and the organisation behind it?

And trust is particularly important.

Who wrote this?

Why should I believe it?

Can I verify it?

Does the business actually exist?

Are there real contact details?

Are there genuine examples?

Are claims supported?

Does the site make it clear who is responsible for the information?

That's much more useful than trying to game a fictional score.

First-hand experience

Experience is particularly interesting.

Suppose I'm writing about a phone that won't charge.

I can produce an article from generic information.

Or I can explain:

"We see this fault regularly."

"Very often, it's pocket lint packed into the charging port."

"Here's what happened on a recent job."

"Here are the three things we check first."

"Here's the point where you should stop troubleshooting and bring it in."

That's first-hand experience.

It can make content more useful because you're bringing something to the page that isn't simply a rewrite of everything already online.

And this is one reason businesses have a huge advantage if they actually document what they do.

[Slow down. This is the line business owners should take away.]

Your real work contains information.

Your jobs contain questions.

Your customers contain questions.

Your staff contain expertise.

Your mistakes contain lessons.

Your projects contain evidence.

Your case studies contain experience.

That is content.

Author SEO

This brings us to authors.

If you're publishing expert material, especially in areas where expertise matters, don't automatically hide the person who wrote it.

Give the reader context.

Who is the author?

What do they do?

What experience do they have?

Why are they qualified to discuss this?

If appropriate, create an author page.

Link the author to their profile.

Use accurate author information and appropriate structured data where supported.

But don't manufacture credentials.

If someone has ten years of experience, say that if it is true.

If they have a qualification, say what it is if relevant.

If they don't have specialist credentials, don't invent them.

SEO works much better when you stop thinking about how to look authoritative and start thinking about how to be useful and trustworthy.

Layer six: conversion

[Layer card: 6 / CONVERSION]

*And the last layer of the door is the last of the six stages from earlier. Clicked is not converted.

Here's another simple principle.

Don't make the visitor work to discover whether they're in the right place.

If someone searched:

"cracked iPhone screen repair Leeds"

and your page starts with:

[Screen: a page that opens with a wall of company history above the fold.]

"Welcome to our website. We are a family-run company founded in..."

you've made them wait.

Tell them what the page is about.

Then give them the information they need.

Then establish credibility.

Then explain the service.

Then answer questions.

Then make the next step obvious.

SEO and conversion optimisation overlap here.

Because getting someone to the page is only half the job.

*That's the door. Six layers, one place. And now that every place is open, the next question is how you know any of it is working.

Part Nine: Measuring it

[Chapter card: PART NINE / MEASURING IT. Corner badge: all five places lit.]

Search Console

Now let's talk about one of the most important free tools available to a website owner.

Google Search Console.

[Screen: Search Console overview on a demo or permitted property. Blur any client data.]

If you own a website and you don't have Search Console configured, you're missing one of the most useful windows into how Google sees your site.

[On screen: Source: Search Console Help, "About Search Console"]

Google describes Search Console as a tool for monitoring and understanding a site's performance in Google Search, including crawling, indexing and performance.

Inside it, you can investigate things such as:

[Screen: the cursor moves through each report as it is named.]

Queries.

Impressions.

Clicks.

Click-through rate.

Average position.

Pages.

Indexing.

URL inspection.

Sitemaps.

Core Web Vitals.

Search appearance.

And other reports depending on the site.

Impressions

[Screen: Performance report, impressions line highlighted.]

An impression is essentially an opportunity for your result to have appeared in a search result.

You can have impressions without clicks.

That's useful.

Because it tells you:

Google is showing this page for something.

Now ask:

What query?

What position?

What page?

Is the result attractive?

Is the title clear?

Is the page actually answering the intent?

Clicks

Clicks tell you that somebody selected your result.

Now you've moved one step further.

But clicks still aren't customers.

You can have 10,000 clicks and terrible business results.

Or 100 highly relevant clicks and excellent business results.

That's why SEO metrics should eventually connect to business outcomes.

Calls.

Bookings.

Leads.

Sales.

Applications.

Downloads.

Whatever the business actually needs.

CTR

CTR is click-through rate.

Broadly:

How often did people click compared with how often the result was shown?

It's useful.

But don't reduce SEO to:

"Get the CTR as high as possible."

Context matters.

A high CTR on the wrong audience isn't necessarily useful.

And a lower CTR for a highly specific query may still produce excellent customers.

[Text on screen.]

Metrics are evidence.

They're not the objective.

Average position

Then there's average position.

This one gets misunderstood constantly.

People want:

"What is my position?"

But search results vary.

Queries differ.

Locations differ.

Devices differ.

Search features change.

Personalisation and context can matter.

So average position is a measurement across a set of impressions, not a permanent physical position engraved into Google.

Don't treat it as:

"My website is number 4."

Treat it as:

"Across this data set, this is the reported average position."

That's much more accurate.

URL Inspection

Search Console's URL Inspection tool can be incredibly useful.

[Screen: URL Inspection on a single URL, showing index status.]

You can investigate a specific URL.

Is it indexed?

What does Google report?

Are there issues?

Can you request indexing where appropriate?

But again:

Requesting indexing isn't requesting a ranking.

You're not pressing a button saying:

"Please make this number one."

You're asking Google to consider the URL for crawling/indexing.

The ranking question comes later.

Part Ten: The system

[Chapter card: PART TEN / THE SYSTEM. Face.]

SEO is not a button

This is a theme I want you to notice.

[Montage: every SIGNAL, NOT A SWITCH tag from earlier in the video, in quick succession.]

Again and again, SEO doesn't work like a button.

You don't:

[Graphic: each "→ rank" line appears and is struck through.]

add sitemap → rank.

Add schema → rank.

Get 100 reviews → rank.

Get a PageSpeed score of 100 → rank.

Publish 50 blogs → rank.

Buy backlinks → rank.

Add keywords → rank.

That's not how this works.

You are building a system.

And that system is evaluated through many different signals and processes.

The website as a system

Think about your website as an ecosystem.

[Graphic: the five places, with each line below attaching to the place it belongs to.]

The technical layer lets systems access it.

The information architecture organises it.

The content explains what you do.

The pages target real needs.

Internal links connect the information.

Structured data can clarify certain entities and relationships.

Authors can provide context.

Experience can make content genuinely useful.

Performance affects how the page behaves.

Accessibility affects who can use it.

Local information connects your business to places.

Reviews provide reputation.

External links and mentions can contribute to prominence.

And Search Console gives you evidence about what is happening in Google Search.

None of these exists in isolation.

The three levels of SEO

*Here's a second way to look at the same system.

*The five places tell you where you can be seen. These three levels tell you what has to be true in every one of them.

If you want an even simpler model, think of SEO in three layers.

[Graphic: three stacked tiers, FOUND / UNDERSTOOD / CHOSEN.]

Layer one:

Can you be found?

Technical accessibility.

Crawling.

Indexing.

Discoverability.

Layer two:

Can you be understood and considered relevant?

Content.

Intent.

Keywords.

Structure.

Local information.

Entities.

Experience.

Expertise.

Layer three:

Will people trust and choose you?

Reputation.

Reviews.

Evidence.

Website experience.

Brand.

Conversion.

That's a much more useful model than:

"SEO equals keywords."

Organic SEO and compounding

Now we get to one of the most misunderstood ideas in SEO.

Compounding.

Imagine a business that gets:

10 organic visits a day.

Then, over time:

1,000.

It is possible to build organic search traffic without buying Google Ads.

But I want to be extremely careful here.

[Face. Direct. This is a disclaimer delivered as a principle, not small print.]

I'm not promising you will go from 10 to 1,000.

SEO doesn't work like an investment calculator.

There is no guaranteed growth curve.

But the reason people talk about compounding is that useful search visibility can accumulate.

You create useful pages.

Those pages begin appearing for relevant searches.

You learn from the data.

You improve them.

You create additional resources.

You earn mentions.

You earn links.

You build reputation.

You answer more questions.

You cover more relevant demand.

You improve your internal architecture.

Your brand becomes more recognisable.

And the whole system can become larger and more useful over time.

That's the compounding idea.

Not:

"Google rewards old websites."

But:

The information asset you've built can become larger and more valuable.

SEO is an asset, if you actually build one

This is where SEO differs fundamentally from simply buying traffic.

If you spend £500 on Google Ads today, you can potentially buy traffic today.

But stop paying and the paid traffic stops.

SEO isn't free.

It costs time.

It costs expertise.

It can cost writers.

Developers.

Photographers.

Designers.

SEO specialists.

Research.

Technology.

Content production.

But you're attempting to build something that continues to exist after the individual piece of work is finished.

A useful service page can keep attracting relevant searches.

A genuinely useful guide can keep answering questions.

A strong reputation can keep helping people choose you.

A well-structured website can continue to work.

That's why I think of good SEO as building an information asset.

Google Ads

And that brings us to Google Ads.

SEO and Google Ads are not enemies.

They're different tools.

Paid search can be extremely useful when you need immediate visibility.

A new service launch.

A seasonal promotion.

A temporary offer.

A new market.

Testing demand.

A time-sensitive campaign.

Building awareness around something new.

And paid campaigns can be useful alongside other marketing systems, including efforts to turn visitors into owned audiences such as email subscribers, where appropriate.

But paid visibility is paid visibility.

You rent that exposure.

Organic search is an attempt to build durable discoverability.

Neither statement makes one universally better.

They solve different problems.

And I'll do a separate video on Google Ads because there is a lot more to say there.

And this is why SEO takes time

Good SEO can take months.

Sometimes longer.

Not because SEO is magic.

Because building useful infrastructure takes time.

Google has to discover and process changes.

Content has to establish itself.

Competitors don't disappear.

Reputation doesn't appear overnight.

Links and mentions take time.

Customers take time to generate reviews.

Search demand changes.

And you need enough data to know what is actually happening.

So if somebody tells you:

"Give me seven days and I'll dominate Google."

Be very careful.

A short-term technical fix can happen quickly.

A broken page can be fixed today.

A noindex directive can be removed today.

A title can be changed today.

A bad redirect can be fixed today.

But building sustainable visibility is different.

The long game

SEO is the long game because you're building an information system around a business.

The website becomes clearer.

The content becomes better.

The technical foundation becomes stronger.

The business becomes more visible.

The reputation becomes more established.

The data becomes more useful.

And you learn what customers actually ask.

That is the asset.

*So that's the system. Now, how do you actually work on all of this without wasting your time?

Part Eleven: Doing the work

[Chapter card: PART ELEVEN / DOING THE WORK]

SEO order of operations

Here's the order I would generally think about it.

[Graphic: a numbered ladder builds, one rung per stage.]

First:

Make the business understandable.

Who are you?

What do you sell?

Where do you operate?

Who do you serve?

What makes you relevant?

Then:

Make the website technically accessible.

Can important pages be crawled?

Can they be indexed?

Are important URLs working?

Is the architecture sensible?

Are there accidental noindex directives?

Are redirects correct?

Are there major technical failures?

Then:

Build useful pages.

Create the pages that customers actually need.

Service pages.

Product pages.

Location pages where justified.

Guides.

FAQs where genuinely useful.

Case studies.

Supporting resources.

Then:

Match those pages to real search intent.

What does the customer actually want?

What questions are they asking?

What information do they need?

Then:

Build trust and reputation.

Real work.

Real evidence.

Real reviews.

Real authors.

Real expertise.

Real relationships.

Real mentions.

Then:

Measure.

Search Console.

Analytics.

Conversions.

Calls.

Bookings.

Sales.

Then:

Improve.

And repeat.

That's SEO.

Not:

"Publish 500 articles and pray."

The biggest SEO mistake: activity isn't progress

One of the worst SEO habits is measuring output rather than usefulness.

"We published 50 articles."

Okay.

Did they attract the right searches?

Did anyone read them?

Did they help customers?

Did they create enquiries?

Did they answer genuine questions?

Did they strengthen the site's topical coverage?

Did they earn references?

Did they become useful resources?

Or did you simply produce 50 pages?

And I think the biggest mistake businesses make is confusing activity with progress.

[Played as a two-voice exchange. Jordan asks; the answers appear as on-screen text or a second take.]

They say:

"We've done SEO."

What did you do?

"We wrote six blogs."

Okay.

Why?

"We changed our metadata."

Why?

"We added keywords."

Why?

"We got an SEO report."

Okay.

What actually changed?

That's the question.

Did your business become easier to understand?

Did an important page become indexable?

Did a broken customer journey get fixed?

Did you create a genuinely useful resource?

Did you answer a high-intent search?

Did your local presence become more accurate?

Did customers leave genuine reviews?

Did your site become easier to use?

Did search visibility improve?

Did enquiries improve?

That's progress.

What SEO is not

Let's make a list.

SEO is not:

[Graphic: each item appears and is stamped NOT.]

Buying number one.

Keyword stuffing.

Publishing endless rubbish.

Changing a keyword five times.

Buying fake reviews.

Creating hundreds of town pages with identical text.

Getting a perfect PageSpeed score.

Adding every possible schema type.

Buying a mysterious "SEO package."

Receiving a monthly PDF and assuming work happened.

Being promised guaranteed number one rankings.

And it definitely isn't:

"Give me £500 and I'll tell Google to put you first."

Nobody legitimately controls Google's organic ranking system.

And Google's own documentation explicitly warns that there is no way to request or pay for better local ranking.

Spam

And there is a more serious reason to avoid shortcuts.

Search engines have spam policies.

[On screen: Source: Google Search Central, "Spam policies for Google web search"]

Google defines spam in Search as practices intended to deceive users or manipulate Search systems into giving content greater prominence, and says policy-violating content can rank lower or disappear from results altogether.

So the question shouldn't simply be:

"Can I get away with this?"

It should be:

"Am I actually making this better for the person searching?"

That is a much healthier SEO question.

SEO is a loop

Good SEO is a loop.

[Graphic: a circular loop, each word a node.]

Research.

Build.

Publish.

Measure.

Learn.

Improve.

Repeat.

You don't finish SEO.

Just like you don't finish having a website.

You don't finish understanding your customers.

Markets change.

Products change.

Search behaviour changes.

Competitors change.

Search interfaces change.

Technology changes.

Your own business changes.

So the SEO process changes too.

How I audit a business

And this is how I would approach an SEO audit.

Not:

"Let's check your keyword density."

I'd start with the business.

[Graphic: the five places badge. Each place lights as the audit reaches it.]

What does this business actually sell?

Where?

To whom?

What searches matter?

Then search.

What appears?

Where does the business appear?

What doesn't appear?

Then the map.

Is the business represented correctly?

Then the website.

Can it be crawled?

Can important pages be indexed?

Are there technical problems?

Then the pages.

Do they match search intent?

Are titles useful?

Are descriptions useful?

Is the content genuinely helpful?

Are internal links sensible?

Are images usable?

Is the site accessible?

Then trust.

Who wrote this?

What evidence exists?

What do customers say?

What external references exist?

Then performance.

How does the website behave?

Then Search Console.

What is Google actually showing?

What queries?

What pages?

What impressions?

What clicks?

What indexing problems?

Then conversion.

What happens after the person arrives?

Can they call?

Can they book?

Can they buy?

Can they understand what happens next?

That's an audit.

Not a PDF full of red, amber and green boxes.

An audit should tell you:

[Text on screen, three lines.]

What is stopping people from finding you?

What is stopping them from choosing you?

What is stopping them from becoming customers?

The business owner's SEO checklist

If you run a business, here are the questions I want you to be able to answer.

[Graphic: a checklist scrolls, each item ticking as spoken. Offer it as a downloadable in the description if one exists.]

Can Google find my important pages?

Are my important pages indexed?

Do I know which searches matter to my business?

Does each important service have an appropriate page?

Does each important page satisfy the search intent?

Is my website technically sound?

Is my business information accurate?

Is my local profile complete?

Are my opening hours correct?

Are my services represented accurately?

Do I have genuine customer reviews?

Do I respond to them?

Is my NAP information accurate?

Do I have useful local pages where they are genuinely justified?

Can people understand who wrote my expert content?

Can they see evidence of experience?

Are my images usable?

Is my website accessible?

Does it work properly on mobile?

Does it load reasonably quickly?

Have I looked at Search Console?

Do I know what queries generate impressions?

Do I know which pages generate clicks?

Can visitors actually contact me?

And most importantly:

Am I measuring business outcomes, not just SEO activity?

What should you do tomorrow?

If you've watched all of this and you're thinking:

"Okay. Where do I start?"

Don't start by writing 100 blog posts.

Don't start by buying backlinks.

Don't start by changing 500 keywords.

Start with the fundamentals.

Search for the things your customers actually search for.

Look at what appears.

Look at the map.

Look at the organic results.

Look at the questions.

Look at the competitors.

Look at your own site.

Then open Search Console.

Look at your pages.

Look at the queries.

Look at impressions.

Look at clicks.

Look at indexing.

Run your site through PageSpeed Insights.

Check the mobile experience.

Check the important pages.

Check your business profile.

Check your reviews.

And then fix the biggest problems first.

Not the easiest problems.

The biggest ones.

The close

[Chapter card: THE CLOSE. Face. Music lifts slightly.]

The audit

[Lower-third appears and holds through this beat: VERYSEOLY.COM/AUDIT]

And if you want a starting point for that, I've put an audit tool at:

veryseoly.com/audit

You don't need to give me your email.

You don't need to book a sales call.

You run the audit.

It takes roughly twenty seconds.

It looks at the major things you should know about.

And importantly:

It won't tell you everything.

No automated audit can.

It gives you a starting point.

Then you investigate.

Because SEO isn't a score.

It's a system.

[Verify every claim in this beat against the live tool before filming. See Pre-filming checks.]

The real goal

And ultimately, ranking isn't actually the goal.

Visibility is a step toward the goal.

Traffic is a step toward the goal.

The goal is whatever the business needs.

A booking.

A phone call.

A sale.

A consultation.

A shop visit.

A download.

A subscription.

An application.

A customer.

And sometimes the best SEO decision is not:

"How do I get more traffic?"

It is:

"How do I get more of the right people?"

The five places, one last time

[Graphic: the five places badge returns to full screen and lights one place at a time.]

So let's bring it all together.

When somebody searches for something you sell:

One — the answer.

Can your information be understood and surfaced in the answer layer?

Two — the map.

Can your local business be discovered where geography matters?

Three — the links.

Can your pages appear in the organic results?

Four — the reviews.

Can potential customers see evidence from other customers?

Five — the door.

When they arrive at your website, does it actually work?

And inside that door are all the technical foundations:

[Graphic: the door opens; the list scrolls through it.]

Crawling.

Indexing.

Rendering.

Internal links.

Canonicals.

Redirects.

Mobile.

Performance.

Accessibility.

Structured data.

Content.

Authors.

Images.

Conversion.

Trust.

That's the whole system.

*So from now on, when somebody searches for something you sell, ask:

Can I appear in the answer?

Can I appear on the map?

Can I appear in the links?

Can I appear through reviews?

And when someone reaches the door, does the website actually do its job?

That's the framework.

Final thought

[Music lowers. Tight framing. Direct eye contact. Fully memorised.]

The biggest change I want you to make after watching this video is how you think about SEO.

Stop thinking:

"How do I trick Google?"

Start thinking:

"What is my customer searching for?"

"Where are they searching?"

"What are they trying to accomplish?"

"What information do they need?"

"Can search systems understand that I provide it?"

"Can people trust me?"

"Can they actually use my website?"

"And when they find me, can they become a customer?"

That's SEO.

Not one trick.

Not one keyword.

Not one plugin.

Not one report.

Not one backlink.

Not one AI tool.

Not one Google Business Profile setting.

The whole thing.

And if you remember nothing else, remember the five places.

The answer.

The map.

The links.

The reviews.

The door.

Because the customer doesn't necessarily begin by asking:

"Who is the best business?"

They ask:

"What can solve my problem?"

And search decides what they see.

So the game isn't simply being the best business.

It's making sure the things you've built, the expertise you've earned, the reputation you've developed, and the services you provide are actually discoverable.

Because:

[Hold. Let the silence land before the line.]

Not who is best.

Who is visible.

I'm Jordan Gilbert.

This is VerySEOLy.

And now you understand the whole of SEO.

[End card, 15 seconds: NOT WHO'S BEST. WHO'S VISIBLE. / FREE SEO AUDIT: VERYSEOLY.COM/AUDIT (large) / Subscribe button / Suggested video: EP01, The Law of Business Just Broke / VerySEOLy logo]

Production

Everything on screen comes from Jortech, a demo site, a fictional business, or a property you have permission to show. Blur client and customer data.

Recurring graphics (build once, reuse throughout)

Graphic	First use	Reused
Five places badge (ANSWER / MAP / LINKS / REVIEWS / DOOR), current place lit	Part Two	Corner of frame from Part Four to the close; full screen in the audit method and the recap
Chapter card (PART N / NAME)	Part One	Every part, and PLACE N cards for Parts Four to Eight
Door layer card (1 / TECHNICAL ... 6 / CONVERSION)	Part Eight	Six times
Refrain tag: SIGNAL, NOT A SWITCH	Structured data	Meta descriptions, canonicals; montage in "SEO is not a button"
Source caption, lower left, 4 seconds	Part One	Every Google claim (list below)
Text-on-screen pull quote	"SEO is the work of making..."	Every line marked [<i>Text on screen</i>]

Screen recordings to capture

1. Search results for a local-service query showing an AI Overview, map pack, organic links, reviews, images, video and ads, for the cold open
2. Search bars on YouTube, Amazon, Instagram, Facebook, Maps, a marketplace and a site search
3. Typed queries: phone screen, cracked iPhone screen repair near me, how to fix a phone that won't charge, iPhone 15 screen replacement cost, Jortech phone number
4. An AI Overview, a featured result and a knowledge panel, for the answer
5. Clean Organization or LocalBusiness structured data beside its page (illustrative)
6. "coffee shop" map packs in Amsterdam and Manchester (use location settings or a VPN)
7. Jortech's Google Business Profile, complete and accurate
8. Four near-identical town pages in browser tabs
9. A single organic result with the title and snippet highlighted in turn
10. robots.txt, a noindex meta tag in page source, three canonical URL variants
11. A heading outline building on a demo page, and keyword stuffing highlighted across a page
12. PageSpeed Insights on a demo site, and a layout-shift example on a phone

13. Keyboard-only navigation with a visible focus ring, and a screen reader on a labelled form
14. Search Console: overview, Performance (impressions, clicks, CTR, position), Pages, URL Inspection
15. A page that opens with company history instead of what the visitor searched for

B-roll to shoot

1. A high street; a phone coming out of a pocket (cold open)
2. A locked front door, then a decorated hallway behind it (the door)
3. Phone searches in a shop, a parked car and walking down a street (mobile)
4. Jordan at the desk, reviewing a site, for cover under the long list beats

Graphics to build

Person $\leftarrow$ SEO $\rightarrow$ information; the SEO types tiling then collapsing into one line; the tech repair demand map; relevance, distance, prominence; the NAP mismatch; the service by town grid lighting only earned cells; the six-stage pipeline; status code cards; the website floor plan with doors; Core Web Vitals cards; found, understood, chosen tiers; the order of operations ladder; the research loop; the " $\rightarrow$ rank" lines struck through; the checklist.

On-screen source captions, in order

Where	Caption
Part One, AI features in search	Source: Google Search Central, "AI features and your website"
Part Four, AI Overviews and AI Mode	Source: Google Search Central, "AI features and your website"
Part Four, structured data	Source: Google Search Central, "Introduction to structured data"
Part Five, relevance, distance, prominence	Source: Google Business Profile Help, "Tips to improve your local ranking on Google"
Part Six, crawling, indexing and serving	Source: Google Search Central, "In-depth guide to how Google Search works"
Part Seven, fake and incentivised reviews	Source: Google Maps user-contributed content policy
Part Eight, page experience and Core Web Vitals	Source: Google Search Central, "Understanding page experience in Google Search results"

Where	Caption
Part Nine, Search Console	Source: Search Console Help, "About Search Console"
Part Eleven, spam	Source: Google Search Central, "Spam policies for Google web search"

Source notes

Every Google claim spoken in the script, with the page it comes from. **I couldn't open these pages to check them:** this session's network blocks Google's help sites. The links and wording are from my own knowledge, so open each one and confirm the wording still holds before you publish. Google renames and moves these pages often.

Claim as spoken	Part	Source
AI features are part of Search appearance; AI Overviews and AI Mode are search features	One, Four	AI features and your website
Structured data helps Google understand a page and can make it eligible for rich results; it does not guarantee them	Four	Introduction to structured data
Local results are based mainly on relevance, distance and prominence; prominence draws on links and reviews; there is no way to request or pay for a better local ranking; keep information complete, respond to reviews, add photos	Five, Seven, Eleven	Tips to improve your local ranking on Google
Understanding crawling, indexing and serving helps diagnose Search issues	Six	In-depth guide to how Google Search works
Google may use the meta description for the snippet; the snippet varies by query	Six	Control your snippets in search results
Fake reviews and paid or incentivised reviews are prohibited	Seven	Maps user-contributed content policy (check the "fake engagement" section)

Claim as spoken	Part	Source
Core ranking systems use page experience signals; Core Web Vitals are used by ranking systems; good scores don't guarantee top rankings; don't chase a perfect score only for SEO	Eight	Understanding page experience
Core Web Vitals are LCP, INP and CLS (INP replaced FID in March 2024)	Eight	Web Vitals
Search Console helps you monitor and understand performance in Google Search, including crawling and indexing	Nine	About Search Console
Spam is content meant to deceive users or manipulate Search; violating content can rank lower or not appear	Eleven	Spam policies for Google web search

Claims that are Jordan's own, not Google's. These are fine as stated, but they must stay true: the noindex booking page on Jortech; Jortech's services as listed; "I'll do a separate video on Google Ads"; everything about the audit tool (see Pre-filming checks).

YouTube description, chapters and tags

The chapter times are estimates. Replace them with the real ones from the edit before publishing; YouTube needs the first chapter at 00:00.

When someone searches for what you sell, they never see every business that could help them. They see the ones that are visible. Not who is best. Who is visible.

This is the whole of SEO, explained properly: how search works, what SEO actually is, and the five places your business can be found when somebody searches. The answer. The map. The links. The reviews. The door.

No tricks, no guaranteed rankings, no jargon for its own sake. Just the system, and how to work on it without wasting your time.

00:00 Not who is best. Who is visible.

02:31 What is a search engine, and what is SEO?

07:18 The five places your business can be found
09:26 Search intent and keyword research
13:32 Place one: the answer (AI features, structured data)
16:03 Place two: the map (local SEO, Business Profile, NAP)
22:30 Place three: the links (crawled, indexed, ranked, clicked)
26:25 Place four: the reviews
28:56 Place five: the door (technical SEO)
36:34 The door: content
41:10 The door: performance and Core Web Vitals
43:36 The door: accessibility
46:17 The door: trust and E-E-A-T
49:23 The door: conversion
52:14 Measuring it: Search Console
55:42 The system: compounding, Google Ads, the long game
62:23 Doing the work: order of operations and how to audit
70:45 The five places, one last time

Free SEO audit: <https://veryseoly.com/audit>

VerySEOnly is a UK web and marketing studio operated by TicketWave HQ Ltd. We build and run websites and systems for businesses.

Pinned comment: "The five places, in one line: the answer, the map, the links, the reviews, the door. Start with your own business here: <https://veryseoly.com/audit>"

Tags: seo explained, what is seo, how seo works, seo for small business uk, local seo, google business profile, technical seo, search console, core web vitals, e-e-a-t, keyword research, search intent, ai overviews, seo audit, jordan gilbert, veryseoly

Delivery notes and pre-filming checks

Delivery

- **Register: the calm expert.** You are explaining a system you know inside out, not selling it. Slower than EP01, warmer, with the same certainty.
- **One line at a time is a delivery instruction.** Let each line land. The long lists (trades, platforms, SEO types, the checklist) are rhythm, not reading: build pace through them and let the screen carry the variety.
- **Know these by heart:** the cold open, the five places introduction, the noindex confession, and the final thought. Use a teleprompter for everything else.
- **Film it in blocks.** A 75-minute script is not one take. Film by part, reset between parts, and keep framing and light consistent across days. Chapter cards hide the joins.
- **The refrain:** say "signal, not a switch" the same way every time. It should feel like a running joke the viewer is in on by Part Ten.

- **Music:** none in the cold open; a low bed from Part One; drop it out for the noindex confession; lift slightly for the close; lower it under the final thought.
- **The + marks** show lines added to your draft. Remove them for the teleprompter.

Pre-filming checks

- ☐ **Confirm the audit tool matches the script.** The close says: no email needed, no sales call, you run it yourself, about twenty seconds. EP01 describes a requested audit that "takes about a minute to request". Only one of these can be true, so fix whichever script is wrong.
- ☐ **Open every source link** in Source notes and confirm Google's wording hasn't changed.
- ☐ **Confirm the noindex story is accurate as told**, including roughly how long the Jortech booking page carried noindex.
- ☐ **Check the Jortech examples against reality.** The lower-third URL (jortech.co.uk); iPhone screen, battery, charging port and water damage repairs; laptop screen and keyboard replacement; console repair; data recovery; Leeds as the example location. Change anything Jortech doesn't actually do or say.
- ☐ **Decide on the ChatGPT line** in Part Four ("Make ChatGPT recommend my business"). It is accurate and makes the point, but it names a rival AI product on a channel whose flagship episode is built around Claude.
- ☐ **Clear permission for every property shown on screen**, or use demo data.
- ☐ **After the edit**, replace the estimated timestamps in the structure table, description and chapters with the real ones.
- ☐ **Link the checklist** in the description if you make it downloadable, and add the Google Ads video to the end screen once it exists.